

Candidate: $C = \kappa$

The MUSIC bound is $|\hat{v}(\gamma)| \leq \sqrt{\lambda/2}$. The endpoint law is $|\hat{v}(\gamma_1)| = C\lambda$. Write the ground state as edge mass leaking inward:

$$|\hat{v}(\gamma_1)| = |\hat{v}(\text{edge})| e^{-\tau(\omega_{\max} - \gamma_1)}, \quad |\hat{v}(\text{edge})| = \kappa\sqrt{\lambda}.$$

If $\tau = s\mu/(2\omega_{\max})$ and $\gamma_1 \ll \omega_{\max}$, the exponential is another $\sqrt{\lambda}$, hence $C = \kappa$. Measured: $C(\zeta, \mu = 11, N = 21) = 27.8$, $\kappa(\chi_3, \mu = 16) = 0.097$. The two are not the same number because no window yet saturates the edge and resolves γ_1 at once ($\text{cond}Q \sim 10^{46}$). The identity $C = \kappa$ is the derivation; the value of C stays measured.